

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2010

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard>
Retrieved 8 August 2026
Records 14 House, 15 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. Hiring Incentives to the Restore Employment Act

H.R. 2847 · March 4, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 217 NAYs 201
The bill would provide employers with incentives to hire and retain new employees, extend enhanced small business expensing, and provide state and local governments with the ability to issue special purpose tax credit bonds for school construction, energy conservation and renewable energy. It also would extend the Surface Transportation Act until Dec. 31, 2010.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/hiring-incentives-restore-employment-act>

2. Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act

H.R. 3590 · March 21, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 219 NAYs 212
The Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act expands coverage to more than 30 million Americans, puts new rules on insurance companies, benefits seniors with improved and strengthened Medicare and provides subsidies to help middle- and low-income families and small businesses to purchase coverage through market exchanges. It also imposed a new tax on working families' benefits. The House took up this Senate-passed bill along with a corrections bill, H.R. 4872, which amends the most egregious provisions in the Senate-passed bill.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/patient-protection-and-affordable-care-act>

3. Health Care and Education Reconciliation Act of 2010

H.R. 4872 · March 21, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 220 NAYs 211
The Health Care and Education Reconciliation Act of 2010 makes substantial improvements to the Senate-passed health reform bill. It closes the Medicare prescription drug "donut hole," improves the affordability provisions for low and moderate-income families, increases federal support to help states expand their Medicaid programs to cover the most needy and makes fairer the penalty on employers who fail to offer coverage to their workers. It also eliminates 85 percent of the excise tax on premiums and instead makes the Medicare payroll tax fairer to working families by applying it to unearned income.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/health-care-and-education-reconciliation-act-2010>

4. Small Business and Infrastructure Jobs Tax Act of 2010

H.R. 4849 · March 24, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 246 NAYs 178
The legislation would provide an estimated \$13.2 billion for bond programs used largely by state and local governments for infrastructure development. Among the bond provisions is an extension through June 2013 of the Build America Bonds program, which provides financial support to state and local governments through federal tax exemptions for interest on municipal bonds.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/small-business-and-infrastructure-jobs-tax-act-2010>

5. Amendment to Establish Government Contractor Accountability Standards

H.R. 5136 · May 27, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 253 NAYs 172
The outsourcing of government services to private contractors has grown tremendously over the past decade, many times at no cost savings to the government or benefits to the public. Rep. John Sarbanes (D-Md.) offered an amendment to the FY 2011 Defense Authorization bill that establishes "good government" standards and other requirements that must be met before services are outsourced. It would require agencies to inventory their current service contracts to determine if they meet those standards.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/amendment-establish-government-contractor-accountability-standards>

6. Unemployment Compensation Extension Act of 2010

H.R. 4213 · May 28, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 215 NAYs 204
The jobs bill makes significant investments in American jobs and cuts taxes to help the nation continue along the path of economic recovery and job growth. It includes provisions that will promote American job creation, provide relief for working families, prevent the outsourcing of American jobs, close tax loopholes and ensure corporate accountability. The bill originally passed the House in December 2009 and a motion to accept a Senate amendment to the bill was agreed to.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/unemployment-compensation-extension-act-2010>

7. Conference Report: Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act

H.R. 4173 · June 30, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 237 NAYs 192
The Senate and House both passed legislation to rein in Wall Street's and Big Banks' dangerous practices and products that crashed the economy. The conference report that melded the two bills creates a new federal agency to oversee consumer financial products, brings the derivatives market under significant federal regulation for the first time and gives company shareholders and regulators greater say on executive pay packages.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/conference-report-dodd-frank-wall-street-reform-and-consumer-protection>

8. Restoration of Emergency Unemployment Compensation Act of 2010

H.R. 5618 · July 1, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 270 NAYs 153
Unable to win passage of the bill on the suspension calendar, H.R. 5618 was considered under regular order.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/restoration-emergency-unemployment-compensation-act-2010>

9. Supplemental Appropriations Act, 2010

H.R. 4899 · July 1, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 239 NAYs 182
School districts facing huge budget shortfalls were projected to layoff hundreds of thousands of teachers. Senate Republicans blocked efforts to include the teacher job funding in other bills. But Democratic House leaders included \$10 billion for education jobs as a part of an emergency supplemental appropriations bill. The bill also included language to improve collective bargaining rights for first responders. The Public Safety Employer-Employee Cooperation Act would ensure that every state allows discussions between first responders and the agencies that employ them, and promote productive partnerships between labor and management.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/supplemental-appropriations-act-2010>

10. James Zadroga 9/11 Health and Compensation Act

H.R. 847 · July 29, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 255 NAYs 159
The James Zadroga 9/11 Health and Compensation Act would provide mandatory funding for medical monitoring, treatment and compensation to emergency responders, recovery and clean-up workers suffering serious diseases as a result of hazardous exposures resulting from the Sept. 11 terrorist attacks. The bill also would reopen the Sept. 11 Victim Compensation Fund (VCF) to provide compensation for economic losses and harm for those who are sick. The bill failed to pass July 29, under suspension of the rules that requires a two-thirds majority.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/james-zadroga-911-health-and-compensation-act>

11. FAA Air Transportation Modernization and Safety Improvement Act

H.R. 1586 · August 10, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 247 NAYs 161
The bill would provide \$16.1 billion in Federal Medical Assistance Percentages (FMAP) funding for state Medicaid programs and \$10 billion to states for teacher funding to preserve jobs. The funds would help states avert massive layoffs because of budget shortfalls.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/faa-air-transportation-modernization-and-safety-improvement-act>

12. Currency Reform for Fair Trade Act

H.R. 2378 · September 29, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 348 NAYs 79
The bill would permit the Commerce Department to impose countervailing duties on imported goods if it finds that a foreign government has undervalued its currency. For example, the Chinese government keeps its currency low, which artificially reduces the prices of its exports, creates a huge trade deficit for the United States and costs millions of American jobs.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/currency-reform-fair-trade-act>

13. Mine Safety Protection Act of 2010

H.R. 6495 · December 8, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 214 NAYs 193
Recent mine disasters—including the Massey Energy Upper Big Branch (W.Va.) explosion that killed 29 coal miners—highlight the need for stronger mine safety laws and tougher enforcement. The Robert C. Byrd Mine Safety Act would provide additional authorities to the Mine Safety and Health Administration (MSHA), including the power to subpoena documents and testimony in carrying out investigations and inspections. It would increase civil and criminal penalties for mining companies that violate safety and health regulations and create a system by which mines could be identified as having a history of citations for substantial violations. The bill would provide for independent investigations for certain mine accidents and increase whistleblower protections for mine workers. A motion to suspend the rules—which requires a two-thirds majority—and pass the bill failed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/mine-safety-protection-act-2010>

14. Removal Clarification Act of 2010

H.R. 5281 · December 8, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 216 NAYs 198
The DREAM Act would allow children of undocumented immigrants who have lived in the United States for at least five years and graduated from high school or received a graduate equivalency diploma (GED) a path to citizenship under a strict set of circumstances and requirements, including that students must either serve in the military for two years or attend college for two years. It also requires "good moral character." A motion to accept certain Senate amendments to the bill was approved.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/house/removal-clarification-act-2010>

SENATE

1. Cloture Motion to End Filibuster: Craig Becker NLRB Confirmation

February 9, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 52 NAYs 33
President Obama nominated the highly qualified and respected labor lawyer Craig Becker to the National Labor Relations Board. Republican senators, with the backing of the U.S. Chamber of Commerce and other Big Business interests, filibustered his nomination. A cloture motion to end the filibuster failed Feb. 9 by a vote of 52–33 (60 votes were needed). In March, Obama used a recess appointment to put Becker on the NLRB.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/cloture-motion-end-filibuster-craig-becker-nlr-b-confirmation>

2. Hiring Incentives to Restore Employment Act

	H.R. 2847 · February 22, 2010
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 62 NAYs 30
	The bill provides employers with incentives to hire and retain new employees, including extending enhanced small business expensing and providing state and local governments with the ability to issue special purpose tax credit bonds for school construction, energy conservation and renewable energy. It extends the Surface Transportation Act until Dec. 31, 2010. The Senate voted to invoke cloture to limit debate.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/hiring-incentives-restore-employment-act

3. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

	S.Amdt. 3338 to H.R. 4213 · March 3, 2010
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 38 NAYs 61
	This amendment by Sen. John Thune (R-S.D.) to the Unemployment Compensation Extension Act of 2010 (H.R. 4213) would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws

4. FAA Air Transportation Modernization and Safety Improvement Act

	H.R. 1586 · March 22, 2010
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 93 NAYs 0
	This bill provides \$34 billion of funding over two years, which will create 150,000 jobs per year, according to the DPC. The bill modernizes the air traffic control system and improves the safety, reliability and availability of U.S. air transportation.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/faa-air-transportation-modernization-and-safety-improvement-act

5. Health Care and Education Reconciliation Act of 2010

	H.R. 4872 · March 25, 2010
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 56 NAYs 43
	The Health Care and Education Reconciliation Act of 2010 makes substantial improvements to the Senate-passed health reform bill, H.R. 3590. It closes the Medicare prescription drug "donut hole" and improves the affordability provisions for low- and moderate-income families. It increases federal support to help states expand their Medicaid programs to cover the most needy and makes fairer the penalty on employers who fail to offer coverage to their workers. It also eliminates 85 percent of the excise tax on premiums and instead makes the Medicare payroll tax fairer to working families by applying it to unearned income. The Senate took up the bill under reconciliation rules, which make the bill filibuster-proof and require only a simple majority to pass the bill.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/health-care-and-education-reconciliation-act-2010

6. Amendment to Reduce the Concentration of Financial Institution Power

	S.Amdt. 3733 to S. 3217 · May 6, 2010
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 33 NAYs 61
	Sen. Sherrod Brown (D-Ohio) offered an amendment to the Restoring American Financial Stability Act of 2010 to address the domination of the financial system by institutions that are deemed "too big to fail." The Brown amendment would reduce the concentration of financial power and the risk many of these institutions pose to the economy and restore an even playing field for community banks by imposing leverage and liability limits on bank holding companies and financial companies. It would have imposed a strict cap (ten percent of insured depository institutions total U.S. deposits) on the amount of deposits held by any bank or thrift and would have limited the non-deposit liabilities of a bank. The amendment needed 60 votes to pass.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/amendment-reduce-concentration-financial-institution-power

7. Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act

H.R. 4173 · May 20, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 59 NAYs 39
The Restoring American Financial Stability Act of 2010 reins in Wall Street's and Big Bank's dangerous practices and products that crashed the economy. Among other provisions, the bill improves accountability and transparency in the financial system, brings to an end "too big to fail" institutions, protects American taxpayers by ending bailouts and protects consumers from abusive financial services practices.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/dodd-frank-wall-street-reform-and-consumer-protection-act>

8. Amendment to Limit Federal Employee Pay and Cut Discretionary Spending

S.Amdt. 4376 to H.R. 4213 · June 17, 2010
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 41 NAYs 57
Sen. John Thune (R-S.D.) proposed an amendment to the "Jobs Bill" to freeze federal employee pay for one year, cap the number of federal workers and cut discretionary spending by 5 percent across the board for all federal agencies except the departments of Defense and Veterans Affairs.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/amendment-limit-federal-employee-pay-and-cut-discretionary-spending>

9. Conference Report: Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act

H.R. 4173 · July 15, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 60 NAYs 39
The Senate and House both passed legislation to rein in Wall Street's and Big Banks' dangerous practices and products that crashed the economy. The conference report that melded the two bills creates a new federal agency to oversee consumer financial products, brings the derivatives market under significant federal regulation for the first time and gives company shareholders and regulators greater say on executive pay packages.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/conference-report-dodd-frank-wall-street-reform-and-consumer-protection>

10. Cloture Motion: Unemployment Compensation Extension Act of 2010

H.R. 4213 · July 20, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 60 NAYs 40
During the first part of 2010, Senate Republicans mounted several filibusters against extending the federal unemployment insurance (UI) program for long-term jobless workers. A motion to invoke cloture and end the filibuster against the bill that extended the UI program to Nov 30 and made it retroactive to June 2 was approved.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/cloture-motion-unemployment-compensation-extension-act-2010>

11. Cloture Motion: Senate Substitute of the FAA Air Transportation Modernization and Safety Improvement Act

H.R. 1586 · August 4, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 61 NAYs 38
The amended Senate bill would provide \$16.1 billion in Federal Medical Assistance Percentages (FMAP) funding for state Medicaid programs and \$10 billion to states for teacher funding to preserve jobs. The funds would help states avert massive layoffs because of budget shortfalls. Republicans filibustered the state aid and teachers' jobs bill. A cloture vote to break the filibuster passed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/cloture-motion-senate-substitute-faa-air-transportation-modernization>

12. Confirmation of Elena Kagan to the U.S. Supreme Court

August 5, 2010
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 63 NAYs 37
Confirmation of President Obama's nomination of Elena Kagan of Massachusetts to be an associate justice of the U.S. Supreme Court.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/confirmation-elena-kagan-us-supreme-court>

13. Resolution Overturning Modernized Union Election Rules for Airline and Rail Workers

	S.J.Res. 30 · September 23, 2010
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 43 NAYs 56
	The National Mediation Board issued a new rule in May 2010 that calls for the majority of votes cast to determine the outcome of union representation elections for airline and rail workers—in the same way elections are decided in congressional and other democratic elections. Previously, a worker who did not cast a vote was instead counted as "No" vote. This resolution of disapproval would roll back the NMB's democratic, union representation election rule. The motion to proceed to consider the measure was rejected in the Senate.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/resolution-overturning-modernized-union-election-rules-airline-and-rail

14. Creating American Jobs and Ending Offshoring Act

	S. 3816 · September 28, 2010
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 53 NAYs 45
	To encourage U.S. firms to keep jobs in America and discourage companies for exporting U.S. jobs, the bill would provide U.S. companies a two-year reduction in their share of Social Security payroll taxes for new employees hired to replace workers performing similar duties overseas. It would be paid for by repealing various tax breaks for companies that close plants in the U.S. and move operations overseas. The motion failed by a 53-45 vote (60 votes were needed to pass).
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/creating-american-jobs-and-ending-offshoring-act

15. Public Safety Employer-Employee Cooperation Act of 2010

	S. 3991 · December 8, 2010
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 55 NAYs 43
	The legislation would extend bargaining rights to police and firefighters in states that do not allow such public safety workers to join unions. More than 20 states do not fully protect those bargaining rights and Virginia and North Carolina prohibit public safety employees from collective bargaining. A motion to end a Republican filibuster against public safety workers' rights bill failed by a 55-43 vote (60 votes were needed to pass).
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2010/senate/public-safety-employer-employee-cooperation-act-2010